

# BEN YACKER

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## PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

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Owner-side Construction Project Manager with ownership-level accountability across large-scale mixed-use development and multi-state infrastructure programs totaling \$4B+ in combined value. Experienced across the full project lifecycle, from driving owner design reviews and tenant coordination through subcontractor procurement, budget ownership, and occupancy. Columbia University-educated; delivers results through proactive risk escalation, disciplined trade management, and direct accountability for schedule, budget, and safety outcomes on every project.

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

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### Construction Project Manager | Applegreen

April 2025 – Present

*Multinational energy and convenience retail operator, Blackstone Infrastructure Partners portfolio · 550+ locations across USA, UK & Ireland*

- Own end-to-end delivery of \$200M+ in active site construction value across 80+ service areas as part of a \$1B+ Blackstone-backed capital investment program, directly accountable to ownership for schedule, budget, quality, and safety outcomes across PPP contracts with 6 state highway authorities including NY State Thruway (27 areas), NJ Turnpike Authority (21 areas), PA Turnpike Commission (17 areas), and additional state systems
- Manage design-build delivery across multiple PPP contract sites under a Blackstone Infrastructure Partners-backed investment structure, coordinating integrated design and construction phases, reviewing design submittals for constructability, and managing design-build trade contractors accountable for both engineering and field execution
- Drive 30+ subcontractors to program deadlines across concurrent active sites; own RFP coordination, bid evaluation, and scope negotiation for all multi-state trade contracts, accountable for award decisions aligned with program budget and timeline
- Own end-to-end permitting outcomes across municipal, utility, electrical, and inspection domains in multiple state jurisdictions, maintaining zero permit-related delays through proactive agency coordination and early application strategy
- Personally coordinate medium-voltage utility interconnection process for each site, working with licensed electrical engineers and utility authorities (ConEd, PSEG, PECO, Delmarva Power) on load studies, transformer sizing, and service entrance upgrades from application through energization
- Coordinate standby power system integration at each site, working with electrical engineers on diesel generator sizing, UPS specifications, and automatic transfer switch (ATS) configurations to ensure continuous power availability during grid outages
- Partner with licensed MEP engineers on critical power system design reviews, validating single-line diagrams, load calculations, and utility documents against program specs before field execution
- Oversee energization acceptance testing and commissioning for each installation, coordinating vendors, electrical contractors, and utility authorities to validate service performance prior to site turnover
- Advance state clean energy goals through each contract, directly supporting 100% EV coverage commitments on NY and NJ state highway systems aligned with state clean energy mandates
- Serve as sole owner's representative in all state authority, government agency, and PPP compliance interactions across the program

### Project Coordinator | FRAM+Slokker

2023 – 2025

*award-winning mixed-use developer; Brightwater is one of North America's landmark master-planned communities*

- Served as primary execution lead for senior PM across all active phases of a ~\$3B USD master-planned waterfront development on a remediated former industrial site, with direct accountability for subcontractor performance, RFI resolution, budget tracking, and permitting outcomes across residential, retail, and commercial construction
- Drove owner design review process across SD, DD, and CD phases, coordinating architect and MEP consultant responses to owner comments, tracking design changes against budget and constructability requirements, and ensuring procurement-ready documents on schedule
- Managed landlord work coordination for 300,000+ sq ft of retail and commercial tenant spaces, tracking base-building delivery milestones, sequencing tenant fit-out starts within active construction, and managing shell space handoffs aligned with lease commencement dates

- Owned accountability for \$150M+ in phase-dedicated construction budgets across concurrent active phases; collaborated with development and finance teams on monthly budget reconciliation, tracking construction costs against the pro forma and providing cost analysis for ownership and investor reporting
- Prepared and delivered monthly construction progress reports to the owner and investment committee, providing schedule status, risk assessments, and recovery plan recommendations that informed project-level development decisions
- Drove subcontractor procurement across 25+ active trade contracts spanning structural, mechanical, electrical, plumbing, envelope, and finishing scopes; managed 25+ subcontractors simultaneously from mobilization through final turnover
- Managed change order process on behalf of the owner, evaluating GC proposals for merit, negotiating scope and pricing, and tracking approved changes against phase budgets; identified constructability conflicts during design reviews that reduced post-construction change exposure
- Took direct ownership of subcontractor safety compliance through weekly toolbox talks, safety plan reviews, and site audit protocols, maintaining zero lost-time incidents across all active phases
- Coordinated environmental compliance for development on a remediated former industrial waterfront site, overseeing stormwater controls, erosion and sediment measures, and regulatory reporting; oversaw delivery of 18+ acres of public park and open space
- Processed 400+ RFIs and submittals; led full permitting portfolio including municipal/zoning, building permits, environmental assessments, utility coordination, and occupancy inspections with zero delays across any phase

## EDUCATION

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**Post-Graduate Certificate, Construction Project Management** | *Columbia University*  
*Engineering Division*

**Graduate Certificate, Construction Management** | *George Brown College*  
*Angelo DelZotto School of Construction Management*

**Undergraduate Degree, Building Technology** | *George Brown College*

## CERTIFICATIONS

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OSHA 30-Hour Construction Safety Certification

## TECHNICAL SKILLS & CORE COMPETENCIES

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**Construction Management:** Multi-trade coordination, RFI/submittal management, budget and schedule control, owner's representation, subcontractor procurement, commissioning and turnover

**Permitting & Regulatory:** Municipal/zoning, building permits, environmental assessments, utility coordination, occupancy inspections, multi-state regulatory compliance

**Project Management Software:** Procore, MS Project, Primavera P6, Bluebeam, MS Office Suite

**Design & Engineering Tools:** AutoCAD (reading & markup), BIM/Revit (reading), CAD drawing interpretation

**Infrastructure:** High-voltage electrical coordination, utility authority liaison, PPP contract management, government and agency relations